

# DAK GURU STUDY MATERIAL

Inspector of Posts / PS Group 'B' Examination

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## POSTAL MANUAL VOLUME II

*Organisation, Establishment & General Administration*

❖ **Comprehensive Examination Notes** ❖

Updated & Verified Edition • June 2026

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# DISCLAIMER

## IMPORTANT — PLEASE READ

This booklet has been prepared **strictly from an examination point of view** as a study aid for departmental examination aspirants of the Department of Posts.

Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate the latest amendments, orders, circulars and notifications in force as on the date of this edition. Wherever the original Manual carried historical monetary limits or provisions that have since been superseded, the current position has been indicated through clearly marked update boxes.

This document is intended for learning and revision only and does not constitute an official or legal publication. **Readers are strongly advised to refer to the original Postal Manual Volume II, the relevant Rules, and the latest Government of India gazette notifications and Directorate orders for authoritative and binding information.**

*In case of any conflict between this material and the official sources, the official sources shall always prevail.*



## HOW TO USE THIS EDITION

**Saffron boxes** flag content that has been updated or verified against the latest position.

**Green boxes** explain legislative changes and the current statutory framework.

**Navy boxes** give study notes, memory aids and quick-revision pointers.

## CHAPTER MAP

### Chapter 1 — Organisation

- › Structure, Postal Services Board, 23 Circles, Base Circle, key units, PTCs

### Chapter 3 — Appeals and Petitions

- › Rules 115–122: classification, channel, limitation, withholding

### Chapter 4 — Personal Matters & Legal Proceedings

- › Rules 127–174-A: legal advice, suits, prosecutions, jury exemption

### Chapter 5 — Security Deposits

- › Rules 191–260: who furnishes, forms, verification, refund, destruction

### Chapter 6 — Stock Management

- › Rules 269-B–288: classification, locks & keys, registers, forms supply

### Chapter 7 — Stationery

- › Rules 341-A–371: fixed charges, indents and registers

### Chapter 9 — Contracts

- › Rules 420–431: EMD, performance security (GFR 2017), mail-conveyance forms

### Chapter 10 — Land and Buildings

- › Rules 449–559: hiring, ownership, sale, transfers, rent, amenities

### Chapter 11 — Miscellaneous Rules

- › Protocol, filing systems, service postage, identity cards, budget

### Supplementary Data & Quick Revision

- › Indent deadlines, forms, depot jurisdiction, high-yield points

## Chapter 1 | Organisation

*How the Department of Posts is structured — from the Union Minister at the apex down to the Circle, Region and Division — and the key administrative units that support postal operations across the country.*

### 1. Organisational Structure

The Department of Posts (DoP), branded as India Post, functions under the Ministry of Communications, Government of India. It is one of the two Departments of the Ministry, the other being the Department of Telecommunications. The administrative and operational hierarchy flows from the political executive at the top to the field formations that actually deliver postal services.

#### Political Executive

- **Minister of Communications** — the Cabinet Minister holding overall charge of the Ministry.
- **Minister of State for Communications** — assists the Cabinet Minister.

#### Administrative Head

A single officer of the rank of Secretary to the Government of India heads the Department. Importantly, this one officer holds three capacities simultaneously:

- **Secretary (Posts)** — the administrative head of the Department.
- **Director General Postal Services (DGPS)** — the operational head of the postal network.
- **Ex-officio Chairperson, Postal Services Board** — heads the apex management body.

#### VERIFIED — COMMON EXAM TRAP

The Secretary (Posts), the Director General Postal Services, and the Chairperson of the Postal Services Board are **ONE and the same person**, not three separate authorities. Older notes sometimes list “Secretary” and “Director General” as two different levels in the hierarchy — that is incorrect.

*Source: India Post — “Our Organisation”, [indiapost.gov.in](http://indiapost.gov.in) (verified June 2026).*

### 2. Postal Services Board (PSB)

The Postal Services Board is the apex management body of the Department. It assists the Secretary (Posts) in policy formulation and is responsible for the overall management of the postal network. The Board comprises the Chairperson (Secretary/DG) and seven Members, each holding a defined functional portfolio.

**UPDATED – CURRENT BOARD COMPOSITION**

As per India Post's official “Our Organisation” page, the Board comprises the **Chairperson + 7 Members** holding these portfolios:

- **Member (Personnel)**
- **Member (Operations)**
- **Member (Technology)** — handles Technology & Estates.
- **Member (Financial Services)**
- **Member (HRD)** — Human Resource Development.
- **Member (Infrastructure)**
- **Member (Service Quality & Marketing)** — covers customer satisfaction, philately, media & communication.

Two important officers support the Board without being Members:

- **Additional Secretary & Financial Advisor** — a permanent invitee to the Board.
- **Secretary to the Board** — a senior staff officer of the Directorate who assists the Board.

**STUDY NOTE – EARLIER VS CURRENT PORTFOLIOS**

Older study material listed a “Member (PLI), headed by CGM” and a “Member (Planning & Marketing).” The portfolio names have since been re-organised. PLI is now run as a separate **PLI Directorate** headed by a CGM, and the Board portfolios are as listed above. Always quote the current seven portfolios in the exam.

### 3. Administrative Jurisdictions — Postal Circles

For administrative and operational convenience, the entire country is divided into 23 Postal Circles, each headed by a Chief Postmaster General (CPMG). In general, each Circle is co-terminus with a State; a few Circles also administer adjoining Union Territories or smaller States, as shown below.

**VERIFIED**

The number of Postal Circles is **23** (confirmed by India Post and a Lok Sabha reply, position as on 2025). Andhra Pradesh and Telangana are now separate Circles. There is, additionally, a 24th Circle — the **Base Circle (Army Postal Service)** — which is counted separately from the 23 territorial Circles.

| S.No | Circle         | Headquarters | Jurisdiction / Coverage |
|------|----------------|--------------|-------------------------|
| 1    | Andhra Pradesh | Vijayawada   | Andhra Pradesh          |
| 2    | Assam          | Guwahati     | Assam                   |
| 3    | Bihar          | Patna        | Bihar                   |

|    |                  |                    |                                                                   |
|----|------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4  | Chhattisgarh     | Raipur             | Chhattisgarh                                                      |
| 5  | Delhi            | New Delhi          | Delhi                                                             |
| 6  | Gujarat          | Ahmedabad          | Gujarat + Daman & Diu + Dadra & Nagar Haveli                      |
| 7  | Haryana          | Ambala             | Haryana                                                           |
| 8  | Himachal Pradesh | Shimla             | Himachal Pradesh                                                  |
| 9  | J & K            | Srinagar / Jammu   | Jammu & Kashmir + Ladakh                                          |
| 10 | Jharkhand        | Ranchi             | Jharkhand                                                         |
| 11 | Karnataka        | Bengaluru          | Karnataka                                                         |
| 12 | Kerala           | Thiruvananthapuram | Kerala + Lakshadweep                                              |
| 13 | Madhya Pradesh   | Bhopal             | Madhya Pradesh                                                    |
| 14 | Maharashtra      | Mumbai             | Maharashtra + Goa                                                 |
| 15 | North East       | Shillong           | Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura |
| 16 | Odisha           | Bhubaneswar        | Odisha                                                            |
| 17 | Punjab           | Chandigarh         | Punjab + Chandigarh                                               |
| 18 | Rajasthan        | Jaipur             | Rajasthan                                                         |
| 19 | Tamil Nadu       | Chennai            | Tamil Nadu + Puducherry                                           |
| 20 | Telangana        | Hyderabad          | Telangana                                                         |
| 21 | Uttar Pradesh    | Lucknow            | Uttar Pradesh                                                     |
| 22 | Uttarakhand      | Dehradun           | Uttarakhand                                                       |
| 23 | West Bengal      | Kolkata            | West Bengal + Sikkim + Andaman & Nicobar Islands                  |

#### BASE CIRCLE (ARMY POSTAL SERVICE)

Besides the 23 territorial Circles, the **Base Circle** caters to the postal needs of the Armed Forces. It is headed by an **Additional Director General, Army Postal Service** (in the rank of Major General). Its officer cadre is drawn on deputation from the Civil Posts; **75% of the other ranks** come from the Department of Posts and the remaining **25% are recruited by the Army**.

### Field Hierarchy below the Circle

Each Circle is sub-divided as follows, giving a clear chain of command from the Circle Office down to the smallest Branch Office:

- **Region** — headed by a Postmaster General (PMG).

- **Division** — Postal or RMS Division, headed by a Superintendent / Senior Superintendent of Post Offices (SP/SSP) or of RMS (SRM/SSRM).
- **Sub-Division** — headed by an Inspector of Posts (IP) or Assistant Superintendent of Posts (ASP).
- **Post Offices** — Head Post Office (HO), Sub Post Office (SO) and Branch Post Office (BO).

## 4. Key Administrative & Support Units

### Postal Stores Depots (PSD) / Regional Postal Stores Depots (RPSD)

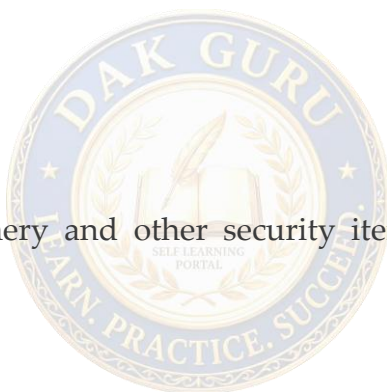
These depots procure, stock and supply forms, stationery, uniforms, locks, bags and other stores to post offices. The principal depots are located at:

- Aligarh (Uttar Pradesh)
- Nashik (Maharashtra)
- Bhubaneswar (Odisha)
- Thrissur (Kerala)
- Kolkata (West Bengal)

### Security Printing Presses

Postage stamps, postal stationery and other security items are printed at the Security Printing Presses located at:

- Nashik (Maharashtra)
- Hyderabad (Telangana)



### Zonal Returned Letter Offices (RLO)

Undeliverable and unclaimed articles that cannot be returned to the sender are dealt with by the Returned Letter Offices. The four zonal RLOs are:

- **Eastern Zone:** Kolkata
- **Western Zone:** Mumbai
- **Northern Zone:** Lucknow
- **Southern Zone:** Chennai

### Postal Training Centres (PTC)

Departmental training is imparted at the national apex academy and the regional Postal Training Centres:





| Training Institution                                      | Location   | PIN     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------|---------|
| <b>RAKNPA</b> (Rafi Ahmed Kidwai National Postal Academy) | Ghaziabad  | 201 002 |
| Postal Training Centre                                    | Guwahati   | 781 001 |
| Postal Training Centre                                    | Vadodara   | 390 001 |
| Postal Training Centre                                    | Mysuru     | 570 010 |
| Postal Training Centre                                    | Madurai    | 625 022 |
| Postal Training Centre                                    | Saharanpur | 247 002 |
| Postal Training Centre                                    | Darbhanga  | 846 005 |

**MEMORY AID – PTC LOCATIONS**

Apex academy = **RAKNPA, Ghaziabad**. The six PTCs — **Guwahati, Vadodara, Mysuru, Madurai, Saharanpur, Darbhanga** — give the Department a training footprint across the North-East, West, South and North.

**LEGISLATIVE UPDATE – POST OFFICE ACT, 2023**

The **Post Office Act, 2023** has repealed the colonial-era **Indian Post Office Act, 1898**. The new Act came into force on **18 June 2024**. It removes the Government's exclusive privilege over letters, contains no offences/penalties of the old kind, and reframes India Post as a citizen-services network. Where older Manual provisions refer to the 1898 Act, read them in light of the 2023 Act.

*Source: Post Office Act, 2023; Gazette / Ministry of Communications notification (effective 18.06.2024).*



## Chapter 3 | Appeals and Petitions

*The rules governing how a Government servant may represent against an order — the difference between an appeal and a petition, the proper channel of submission, time limits, and the circumstances in which a petition may be withheld.*

### Rule 115. Classification of Representations

Any representation made by a Government servant that is not technically an appeal is classified as a petition. A petition that is not made against a decision on a previous communication must be addressed to the authority competent to pass orders on the subject matter, and must be submitted through the proper channel — that is, through the official's immediate superior and onward.

#### STUDY NOTE — APPEAL VS PETITION

An **appeal** is a formal challenge to a specific order under a defined rule (for example, an appeal against a penalty under the CCS (CCA) Rules). A **petition** is the residuary category — any representation that is not an appeal. The petition rules in this chapter therefore cover everything that does not fall under the formal appeal machinery.

### Rule 116. Submission of Petitions

- **Individual submission:** Every employee must submit a petition separately in his or her own name. Joint petitions signed by several employees are inadmissible.
- **Identical petitions:** Separate but identical petitions by several employees are permitted only if the circumstances and conditions represented apply personally to each individual submitting them.
- **Content & language:** A petition must be clear, concise, temperate and respectful in language, and free of irrelevant matter. It must conclude with a specific prayer stating exactly what relief is sought.

### Rule 117. Hierarchy for Submission

A petition to a higher authority against the decision of a lower authority must be accompanied by a copy of the order being challenged, and must be routed through the very officer who passed that order. The channel of submission is as follows:

| Order passed by                | Petition lies to                  | Routed through     |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------|
| Inspector of Posts (IP)        | Superintendent of Post Offices    | the Inspector      |
| Superintendent of Post Offices | Director of Postal Services (DPS) | the Superintendent |

| Order passed by                   | Petition lies to                                                  | Routed through     |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Director of Postal Services (DPS) | Head of Circle (major Circles) / Director General (minor Circles) | the DPS            |
| Head of Circle                    | Director General                                                  | the Head of Circle |

**DISCIPLINARY CASES – CCS (CCA) RULES, 1965**

For matters under the **CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965**, petitions filed after the appellate stage are addressed to the Head of Circle or to the Member (Personnel). A **review petition under Rule 29-A** is submitted to the President.

**Rule 118. Disposal and Transmission**

- **Direct submission:** Petitions sent directly to higher authorities, bypassing the proper channel, are liable to be filed without notice.
- **Forwarding procedure:** The receiving officer must forward the petition to the authority addressed, together with a full statement of the case, all relevant documents, and a definite recommendation.
- **Translation:** If the petition is in a regional language, an English translation must be appended.
- **Competency:** No petition lies to a higher authority unless the next lower competent authority has already been addressed. For instance, a petition against an Inspector's order cannot go directly to the DPS without first addressing the Superintendent.

**Rule 118-D. Limitation Period**

A petition against the order of a lower authority is liable to be **rejected without investigation** if it is submitted more than **6 months** after the date on which the petitioner was informed of the order.

**Rule 120. Withholding of Petitions**

The Head of Circle (or an authority subordinate to the Director General) has discretionary power to withhold a petition addressed to the Director General in certain specified situations. Whenever a petition is withheld, the petitioner must be informed of the fact and of the reasons for it.

**Grounds for Withholding**

- **Transfers:** Petitions about transfers ordered in the interest of service — unless the officer is being transferred frequently at short intervals.



- **Unfitness for permanent employment:** Removal of probationers, temporary officials or learners for being unfit — excluding cases involving specific offences such as fraud.
- **Resignation:** Cases of voluntary, unconditional resignation.
- **Improper language:** Where the petition is illegible, unintelligible, disrespectful or otherwise improper.
- **Repetitive:** Where a previous petition has been disposed of and the fresh petition discloses no new facts.
- **Premature:** Where the lower competent authority has not yet been approached for redress.
- **Time-barred:** Where the petition is submitted after 6 months without reasonable cause for the delay.
- **Employment / exemption:** Applications for employment not based on the rules, or requests for exemption from prescribed qualifications.
- **Termination (temporary service):** Petitions against termination under Rule 5 of the CCS (Temporary Service) Rules, 1965, if submitted after 3 months.

#### MEMORY AID — COUNTING THE 6 MONTHS

The 6-month period for a time-bar is counted from the date of the **original order** — not from the date of any subsequent order passed on reconsideration. Filing a fresh representation does not restart the clock.

### Rule 121. Report of Withheld Petitions

A list of all petitions withheld under Rule 120 must be forwarded **quarterly** to the Director General, so that the exercise of this discretionary power can be monitored.

### Rule 122. Petitions to the President

Petitions addressed to the President must be forwarded to the Director General by the Head of Circle, together with a concise statement of facts and an expression of opinion. Petitions that are merely addressed to the “Chairman” or a “Member” of the Postal Services Board are not treated as petitions to the President or to the Director General, and should be returned to the petitioner for correction.

## Chapter 4 | Personal Matters & Legal Proceedings

*The Department's rules on obtaining legal advice, instituting and defending civil suits, launching criminal prosecutions, signing of complaints, and miscellaneous personal matters such as jury exemption and funeral expenses.*

### Rule 127. Legal Advice and Civil Suits

In important cases arising at or near Kolkata, Chennai, Mumbai, or at other stations where a Government Solicitor or Law Officer is available, that officer's advice must be obtained before proceeding.

#### Institution of Suits

As a general rule, the Head of Circle must obtain the orders of the Director General before:

- instituting a civil suit on behalf of the Department; or
- acting on a notice that a suit is about to be brought against the Department.

#### Exceptions (Delegated Powers)

Heads of Circles need not refer the matter to the Director General in the following cases:

- **Security bonds:** suits connected with the security bonds of postal servants.
- **Transaction losses:** suits regarding Money Orders, Savings Bank transactions and insured articles, provided the amount involved does not exceed the prescribed limit.

#### LEGISLATIVE UPDATE – MONETARY LIMITS

The small rupee figures in the original Manual (for example, Rs. 500 or Rs. 250) are **historical and obsolete**. The current financial powers for instituting or defending suits are governed by the **Schedule of Financial Powers** and the **Delegation of Financial Powers Rules (DFPR), 1978 (as amended)**, which authorise substantially higher limits for Heads of Circles. Always quote the framework, not the old rupee figures.

#### Recoveries from Guarantors

Heads of Circles may sanction civil suits against defaulting guarantors of combined offices to recover deficits, provided that:

- there is a reasonable prospect of realisation; and
- the action is advised by the local Government Solicitor.

### Rule 127-A. Signing of Complaints

All Gazetted Officers of the Department who are fully conversant with the facts of a case are authorised to:

- sign and verify **plaints and written statements** in civil suits filed by or against the Central Government; and
- sign **vakalatnamas** on behalf of the Central Government.

### Rule 133. Institution of Criminal Proceedings

- **Non-cognizable cases:** A prosecution must not be instituted without the previous sanction of the Head of Circle.
- **Emergency exception:** If delay would allow the accused to escape, sanction may be anticipated — but the action must be reported immediately, by email or post, to the Head of Circle.

### Rule 135. Conduct of Prosecutions

On receiving orders to prosecute in a non-cognizable case, the officer must prefer a written complaint before the nearest empowered Magistrate.

### Rule 138. Framing of Charges

- **Three-charges rule:** An accused person may be tried at a single trial for not more than three charges of the same kind.
- **Timeframe:** These three offences must have been committed within a period of 12 months, reckoned from the first offence to the last.

### Rule 146. Employment of Government Pleader

- **Scope:** The Government Pleader generally represents the Government in criminal appeals and Sessions cases, but not in ordinary cases before Magistrates.
- **Fees:** If the Pleader is not obliged to appear without a special fee, engaging his services requires the sanction of the Head of Circle.
- **Ordinary cases:** Ordinarily, no legal assistance should be required for conducting cases before a Magistrate.

### Rule 152. Exemption from Jury Service

All persons employed in the Department of Posts are **exempt** from liability to serve as jurors or assessors in courts of law.

### Rule 174-A. Funeral Expenses

Funeral expenses incidental to the death of a departmental employee in departmental premises, or while on duty at an out-station where the body cannot be attended to by relatives, are to be debited to the **Contingent Grant** of the office concerned.

### CROSS-REFERENCE – STATUTORY FRAMEWORK

With the enactment of the new criminal-law codes, the procedural references in this chapter should be read in their current statutory context: the **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023** has replaced the CrPC, 1973, and the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023** has replaced the Indian Penal Code, 1860 (both in force from 1 July 2024). The Manual's classification of cognizable / non-cognizable offences and the trial procedure now flow from these new codes.

*Source: BNS 2023 & BNSS 2023 (effective 01.07.2024).*





## Chapter 5 | Security Deposits

*Which officials must furnish security against their pecuniary responsibilities, the forms in which security may be given, verification of sureties, refund and destruction of bonds, and the time limits involved.*

### Rule 191. Officials Required to Furnish Security

Because they handle cash, stamps or valuable stock, the following classes of officials are required to furnish security:

#### (i) Circle & Administrative Offices

- Cashiers.
- Managers / Assistant Managers and Assistants in Returned Letter Offices (RLO).
- Group 'C'/Group 'D' staff in Circle Offices and Postal Stores Depots who handle cash or valuable stock.
- Record Suppliers / Daftaries in Stores Depots (for example, Aligarh).

#### (ii) Post Offices & R.M.S.

- Departmental Sub-Postmasters (Classes A, B and C).
- Treasurers and Assistant Treasurers.
- Cashiers in Sub Record Offices / Head Record Offices.
- Sorting Assistants and Mail Guards.
- Head Postmen, Cash Overseers and officials escorting cash.
- Mail Peons, Van Peons, Packers and Runners who handle cash.

### Amount of Security

- **Cash / Savings / Government Notes:** if security is furnished in these forms, the amount required is two-thirds of the standard security amount.
- **Stamp Vendors:** security is fixed at 20 times the vendor's pay, subject to the maximum prescribed by the Department.

### Rule 192. Exemptions

The following may be exempted from furnishing security:

- **High pay / long service:** officials drawing pay above a fixed limit, or who have completed 20 years' service — at the discretion of the Divisional Head.
- **Pensioners:** retired Government servants re-employed as GDS Branch Postmasters, Postmen and the like, provided they are already in receipt of a pension.





### Rule 194. Forms of Security

Security must be furnished in one of the following forms:

- **Cash** — deposited in the Post Office Savings Bank (POSB).
- **Government Promissory Notes** or Post Office Savings Certificates (POSC).
- **Personal Bond** supported by two sureties.

#### IMPORTANT RESTRICTION

Acting Postmen and Village Postmen must **always** furnish security in the form of a **Personal Bond** — they cannot use the cash or promissory-note option.

### Rule 211. Execution of Bonds

For a personal bond, the witness who attests the executant's signature must be an official **above the rank of Postman**.

### Rule 218. Verification of Securities

- **Frequency:** Officers holding custody of bonds must verify the continued existence and solvency of the sureties annually.
- **Scale of verification:** If the total number of bonds is fewer than 40 — verify at least one. If the total exceeds 40 — verify one bond for every 40 (or fraction thereof).
- **Fresh security:** If a surety dies, becomes insolvent or withdraws, the principal must furnish fresh security if he has put in less than 10 years' service.

### Rule 222. Refund of Security

Deposits (cash, notes or certificates) must not be refunded until six months have elapsed from whichever of the following is applicable:

- the date of death or insolvency of the principal;
- the date of notice of withdrawal; or
- the date of the official leaving service.

### Rule 225. Pledging of Security

- **Gazetted Officers:** pledge their security to the Appointing Authority.
- **Non-Gazetted Officers:** pledge their security to their immediate superior, who must be of Gazetted status.



### Rule 227. Custody of Passbooks

Security Deposit Passbooks must be kept by the Head of Office, locked in a **tin box** together with the relevant bonds. The account number must be entered in the Register of Bonds (Form Sec. 19).

### Rule 240. Alteration of Form

An official may, at any time, replace a Personal Bond with a deposit of cash or Government security. The new deposit must be at least **two-thirds** of the standard security amount. Where the deposit is built up by instalments, each instalment deducted must be at least **one-sixth** of the employee's pay.

### Rule 247. Retention and Destruction of Bonds

- **Preservation period:** Expired or replaced bonds must be preserved for 5 years.
- **After 5 years:** Cases of officials who have quit service should be reviewed to see whether further retention is needed (the period of limitation for a breach is 30 years).
- **On promotion:** Bonds of officials promoted to Inspector / Supervisor roles should be preserved for one year after confirmation.

### Rule 249. Inadmissible Sureties

- **Professional money-lenders:** strictly prohibited as sureties.
- **Soldiers:** not accepted as sureties.
- **Ladies:** not advisable, unless they are single or widows and only where no male surety is available.

### Rule 250. Time Limits for Furnishing Security

- **Candidate for a temporary post:** within one month.
- **Candidate for a permanent post:** within three months.
- **Extension:** The Head of Division may extend these periods to three months (temporary) and six months (permanent) respectively.

### Rule 260. Unclaimed Deposits

Security deposits that remain unclaimed for **three years** after they became refundable are credited to Government under the head "**Miscellaneous Revenue**".

## Chapter 6 | Stock Management

*Classification and custody of departmental stock, the strict protocols governing locks and keys, the various stock registers, emergent indents, and the supply of forms with prescribed wastage margins.*

### Rule 269-B. Classification of Stock

Departmental stock is classified into two primary categories:

- **Dead Stock:** durable items such as plant, machinery, furniture and fixtures.
- **Stores:** consumable and perishable articles.

Inventories for both Dead Stock and Stores must be maintained in the Stock Book (**Form S.K.-1**).

### Rule 270. Locks and Keys

Strict protocols govern the custody and repair of locks so as to safeguard cash and valuables:

- **Repairs:** Locks that are damaged or unserviceable must not be repaired locally; they must be returned to the Depot.
- **Keys:** Only one key is supplied with each lock.
- **Lost keys:** If a key is lost, the lock must be broken open and sent to the Depot for replacement, and the cost recovered from the official at fault.
- **Duplicate keys:** Manufacturing or procuring duplicate keys locally is strictly prohibited.
- **Safe keys:** Safes purchased from private manufacturers are supplied with one key; the duplicate is retained in the Depot.
- **Steel almirahs / cabinets:** Where these are supplied with manufacturer-provided duplicate keys, the duplicates are kept in the Divisional Office.

### Rule 271. Custody of Duplicate Keys

- **Divisional Office custody:** Duplicate keys of steel almirahs / cabinets (other than those of the Head of Office) are kept in the Divisional Office in the joint custody of the Office Supervisor / ASPO (HQ) and the Stock Assistant.
- **Head of Office keys:** The duplicate key of the Head of Office's almirah must be sealed in an envelope bearing the Head of Office's personal seal and sent to the Circle Office for safe custody.
- **Retrieval:** If an original key is lost, issue of the duplicate must be authorised by the Divisional Officer, and the duplicate sent by Insured Registered Parcel (insured for Rs. 100).

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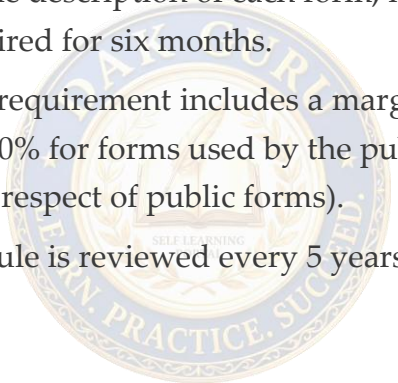
### Rule 272–275. Stock Registers

- **General Stock Book:** maintained in Form S.K.-1 in every office.
- **Stock Register of Bags:** maintained in Form S.K.-1(a) in offices authorised by the Head of Circle.
- **Forms Register:** a stock register of all varieties of forms maintained in Form S.K.-1(b).

### Rule 277. Emergent Indents

- **Purpose:** to meet urgent requirements of articles between the regular supply periods.
- **Frequency:** prepared as and when needed, but ordinarily not more than once a month.
- **Submission:** submitted in triplicate, using Form S.K.-2 or Form Genl.-18.

### Rule 286–288. Supply of Forms

- **Schedule:** The Head of Circle prescribes two six-monthly periods for the supply of forms.
  - **Master Schedule:** shows the description of each form, its average rate of consumption, and the total quantity required for six months.
  - **Wastage margin:** the total requirement includes a margin for wastage — 2% for forms used departmentally and 10% for forms used by the public (up to 15% may be allowed for selected large offices in respect of public forms).
  - **Review:** The Master Schedule is reviewed every 5 years.
- 

## Chapter 7 | Stationery

*Fixed stationery charges allocated to offices and staff, the items eligible for such charges, and the registers and indents through which stationery is managed.*

### Rule 341-A. Fixed Stationery Charges

Fixed stationery charges are allotted to offices and staff for procuring essential consumable items such as sealing wax, twine and glue, so that day-to-day work is not interrupted for want of small stores.

#### LEGISLATIVE UPDATE – MONETARY RATES

The specific rupee rates printed in older Manuals (for example, Rs. 5 or Rs. 25) are **historical and have been superseded**. Current rates are prescribed from time to time by the Postal Directorate / Ministry of Finance. The categories of items eligible for these charges include:

- Cost of closing and sealing mail bags.
- Cost of candles and sealing wax.
- Cost of twine and rubber bands for bundles.
- Stationery charges for clerical staff, Mail Overseers and Mail Peons.

### Rule 366–371. Indents and Registers

- **Register:** the stationery account is maintained in Form S.K.-8.
- **Guard Books:** indented for once in three years.

## Chapter 9 | Contracts

*The responsibilities of officers who employ contractors, the rules on Earnest Money and Performance Security, and the standard forms used for contracts for the conveyance of mails — read together with the current General Financial Rules, 2017.*

### Rule 420. Responsibilities

- **Officer responsibility:** Employing a contractor does not relieve the officer in charge of responsibility for the quality and timeliness of the work.
- **Power to act:** Every contract must give the officer full power to intervene if the contractor delays or fails to perform satisfactorily.
- **Monitoring:** A Register of Contracts must be maintained in Circle, Divisional and First-Class Head Offices. It should be reviewed monthly to identify contracts due to expire within the next 12 months.

### Rule 427. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) / Bid Security

- **Requirement:** Tenders must be accompanied by Earnest Money (Bid Security), generally ranging from 2% to 5% of the estimated value of the goods.
- **Exemptions:** No EMD is required from firms registered with the relevant authority (formerly DGS&D, now procurement through GeM), Micro & Small Enterprises (MSEs / erstwhile SSI units), or Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs), to the extent provided in the rules.

#### VERIFIED — BID SECURITY UNDER GFR 2017

Under **Rule 170 of the GFR, 2017**, Bid Security (EMD) is to be obtained to ensure that a bidder does not withdraw or modify the bid during its validity. The amount is ordinarily **2% to 5%** of the estimated value, as fixed in the bidding documents. (Note: separately, procuring entities now often take a Bid Security Declaration in lieu of EMD.)

*Source: GFR 2017, Rule 170 (Department of Expenditure).*

### Rule 430. Performance Security

After a contract is awarded, the successful bidder furnishes Performance Security to guarantee due performance of the contract. The quantum is fixed in the bidding documents.

#### LEGISLATIVE UPDATE — PERFORMANCE SECURITY %

The original Manual mentions a band of 3–5%. The position has since been amended. Per the **amendment to Rule 171(i) of GFR, 2017** (Ministry of Finance / Department of Expenditure OM dated 01.01.2024, giving effect to OM No. 1/2/2023-PPD dated 03.04.2023), the amount of



Performance Security for goods / consultancy / non-consultancy services has been modified from the earlier **5–10% to 3–10%** of the value of the contract.

For **procurement of works**, performance security plus security deposit / retention money continues to be **3% to 10%**. Performance Security normally remains valid for 60 days beyond completion of all contractual obligations, including the warranty period.

*Source: GFR 2017 Rule 171(i), as amended (DoE OM dated 01.01.2024).*

### Rule 431. Forms of Contract (Conveyance of Mails)

Standard forms are prescribed for contracts for the conveyance of mails by different modes:

| Form    | Purpose                                                      |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| M-50    | Conveyance of mails by wheeled carriages (animal-drawn).     |
| M-50(a) | Conveyance of mails by motor vehicles in rural areas.        |
| M-50(b) | Conveyance of mails by mazdoors, pack mules or ponies.       |
| M-51    | Revised agreement for conveyance of mails by motor vehicles. |

#### MEMORY AID – THE M-50 FAMILY

Think of M-50 as the “mail-conveyance” series. Base **M-50 = carts**; **(a) = rural motor**; **(b) = man / mule / pony**; and **M-51 = revised motor agreement**.



## Chapter 10 | Land and Buildings

*Hiring, ownership, sale and inter-departmental transfer of land and buildings; the basis on which rent is computed for RMS buildings on railway premises; nominal welfare rents; and the scales for staff amenities.*

### Rule 449. Hiring of Buildings

- **Tender:** When a building is to be hired, a tender is called for in Form Genl-22.
- **Lease deed:** The lease for the rented building is drawn up in Form Genl-8.

### Rule 450. Ownership of Buildings

- **Vesting date:** Ownership of all Government buildings occupied by the Department on 1st April 1921 vests in the Department, even if they were originally constructed out of State Revenues.
- **Military buildings:** Ownership of buildings belonging to the Military Department does not vest in the Postal Department, even if they were occupied by it on the vesting date.

### Rule 457. Sale of Land and Buildings

- **Method:** Land belonging to the Department is ordinarily sold through the Revenue Department.
- **Authority:** Permanent departmental buildings and land may be sold under the sanction of the Head of Circle, provided the value does not exceed the prescribed limit (the figure in the source — Rs. 1 lakh — is historical; current powers follow the Schedule of Financial Powers / DFPR).

### Rule 465. Transfer of Assets Between Departments

Specific valuation rules apply when land and buildings are transferred between Central Government departments:

| Transferee Department                          | If NOT valued in books        | If valued in books                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Commercial Departments<br>(excluding Railways) | No charge is made.            | Book Value or Market Value,<br>whichever is less.                                                       |
| Ministry of Defence                            | Half the market value.        | Book Value or Market Value<br>(whichever is less), subject to a<br>minimum of half the market<br>value. |
| Railway Department                             | Full market value is charged. | Full market value is charged in<br>each case.                                                           |

### Rule 499. Project Estimates

Proposals to include original works in the building schedule must be submitted in the **Project Estimate Form (Eng. 110)**, and must reach the Directorate by **15th October** at the latest.

### Rule 502. Revision of Sanction

- **Excess up to 10%:** If expenditure exceeds the sanctioned amount by not more than 10%, no revised sanction is necessary.
- **Excess over 10%:** If the excess is more than 10%, a revised project estimate and preliminary estimate must be prepared for fresh administrative approval and expenditure sanction.

### Rule 529. Rent for RMS Buildings on Railway Premises

Rent for RMS buildings situated on railway land is computed on the following basis:

#### (a) Interest Charges

- **Capital invested after 01.04.1964:** at the Dividend Rate (6%).
- **Capital invested before 01.04.1964:** at 4.5%.

#### (b) Depreciation & Maintenance (Civil Works)

- **Depreciation:** 2% of the original cost of the building (excluding land).
- **Maintenance:** 2.4% of the original cost (excluding land).
- Total for non-residential buildings: **4.4%**.
- **Residential buildings:** 3.9% (maintenance) plus depreciation.

#### (c) Electrical Installations

- **Depreciation & Maintenance:** 8% of the original cost.

### Rule 539. Nominal Rents for Welfare

- **Departmental bodies:** Accommodation provided for canteens, grain shops or co-operative societies run departmentally is charged a nominal rent of Re. 1 per month; no municipal taxes or electricity / water rent is levied.
- **Recreation clubs:** Vacant plots used for tennis courts or games by Postal Recreation Clubs are charged a nominal rent of Re. 1 per annum.

### Rule 559. Staff Amenities — Scales

- **Tiffin rooms:** provided for offices with a staff of 4 or more clerks.
- **Rest rooms:** provided in delivery offices having a minimum strength of 10 delivery staff per shift. **Scale:** minimum 120 sq. ft., plus 12 sq. ft. for every additional person.

## Chapter 11 | Miscellaneous Rules

*A collection of important general-administration rules — national observances and protocol, official correspondence and filing systems, service postage, identity cards, postal maps, periodic reports, and the budget structure of the Department.*

### National Observances & Protocol

- **National Week:** celebrated from 6th to 13th April each year.
- **Flag display:** When the National Flag is displayed in a straight line with the flags of other countries, it must be on the extreme right (the observer's left). It is hoisted first and lowered last.
- **Anthems:** “Vande Mataram” is sung at the beginning of a function; “Jana Gana Mana” (the National Anthem) at the end.

### Rule 616. Use of Ink

Except where some other colour is specifically prescribed, ink other than **blue** should not be used on official correspondence or records.

### Rule 637. Filing System — Superintendent of Post Offices

Correspondence in a Divisional (Postal) Office is filed under standard alphabetical heads, so that any paper can be traced quickly:

| File Head | Class of Correspondence                                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A         | Establishment (creation / revision); opening and closing of offices and lines. |
| B         | Personal matters (appointments, transfers, leave, punishments, service books). |
| C         | Pensions and gratuities.                                                       |
| D         | Buildings and runners' huts.                                                   |
| E         | Accounts, TA, audit references.                                                |
| F         | Robberies, losses and frauds.                                                  |
| G         | Mails (due lists, notices, business hours).                                    |
| H         | Experimental establishments.                                                   |
| I         | Monsoon arrangements.                                                          |
| J         | Indents and contingent expenditure.                                            |
| K         | Annual Report information.                                                     |
| L         | Petty irregularities / miscellaneous.                                          |

### Rule 637. Filing System – Superintendent of Railway Mail Service

In the office of a Superintendent of Railway Mail Service (RMS), correspondence is filed under a parallel but distinct set of heads:

| File Head | Class of Correspondence                                                                                                                   |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A         | Procedure: general orders and rules on mails, unregistered articles, station bundles (paid / unpaid) and registered articles / bundles.   |
| B         | Personal: appointments, leave, punishments, pensions, gratuities, security bonds, service books, character sheets, gradation lists.       |
| C         | Establishment: creation / revision / abolition of establishments, proposition statements, distribution lists.                             |
| D         | Sorting: sorting lists (supply / printing), due-bag statements, sorting mail offices, transit sections, special orders.                   |
| E         | Distribution of work: arrangement of work in offices / vans / sections, changes in jurisdiction / beats, opening and closing of sections. |
| F         | Accommodation: mail vans and buildings (construction, repair, references).                                                                |
| G         | Conveyance of mails: opening of new lines, time-tables, train detention / misconnection, accidents, mail-steamer notices.                 |
| H         | Stock: general stock rules, stationery rate list, supply of bags / forms, uniforms, indents.                                              |
| J         | Accounts: general accounts, permanent advances, fixed contingent allowances, audit references.                                            |
| K         | Investigations: robberies, losses, frauds and serious irregularities.                                                                     |
| M         | Camp articles: movement of high officers and disposal of camp articles.                                                                   |
| Z         | Miscellaneous: minor irregularities (bags, bundles) and matters not included elsewhere.                                                   |

### Rule 666. Service Postage

- **Personal communication:** No personal communication from a departmental official may be sent free “On Service”.
- **Penalty:** A breach attracts a penalty of double the charges that should have been paid, recovered by means of postage stamps.

### Rule 666. Handling of Personal Files & Leave Papers

- **Transfer of officials:** When an official is transferred or deputed for a period exceeding 3 months to another Circle, Division or Office, the personal file / bundle must be forwarded in a Service Registered Cover.

- **Casual leave papers:** Papers relating to casual leave must not form part of the permanent personal file. At the end of each year, all casual-leave papers are destroyed and a fresh series started.

### Rule 694-C. Postal Circle Maps

A skeleton postal map of the Circle must be submitted to the Director General in the month of **June** each year, incorporating all corrections necessitated by changes during the past year, so that the DG's records remain up to date.

### Rule 708. Alphabetical List of Post Offices

The Alphabetical List of Post Offices and the Postal Guide are published annually:

- **Main edition:** published in the month of September.
- **Supplementary:** published in April of the following year.

### Rule 696. Annual Reports

- **To the Head of Circle:** to be submitted by 1st May.
- **To the Director General:** to be submitted before 16th June.

### Rule 721. Identity Cards

The normal life of a departmental Identity Card (**Form Ms-95**) is **4 years**.

## Budget Estimate and Control

### Budget Structure

The Secretary (Department of Posts) acts as the **Chief Accounting Authority**. The Budget Cell in each Circle is headed by the Chief Postmaster General and comprises two units:

- **Budget Control Unit (BCU):** located at the Postal Accounts Office (PAO).
- **Budget Operation Unit (BOU):** located at the Circle Office (CO).

### Rule 756-A. Expenditure Classification

#### LEGISLATIVE UPDATE – PLAN VS NON-PLAN ABOLISHED

The distinction between “Plan” and “Non-Plan” expenditure was **phased out from the Union Budget of 2017-18** onwards. Expenditure is now classified as Revenue and Capital.

- **Revenue Expenditure:** (formerly “Non-Plan”) covers recurring, non-asset-creating items such as salaries, subsidies and interest.
- **Capital Expenditure:** (formerly “Plan”) covers money set aside for productive, asset-creating purposes and projects.

## Supplementary Data & Quick Revision

*Additional high-yield points from Postal Manual Volume II — deadlines for stationery indents, specific forms and registers, jurisdiction of forms depots, and assorted land-and-building and miscellaneous rules frequently asked in the examination.*

### 1. Deadlines for Stationery Indents (Rule 371)

Submission dates for stationery indents are fixed according to the half-year period to which they relate:

| Indent Period Ending | Submit to Supdt. by | Submit to Store Depot by |
|----------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|
| 30th September       | 10th February       | 25th February            |
| 31st March           | 10th August         | 25th August              |

Note: **Guard Books** are indented for once in three years.

### 2. Specific Forms & Registers

- **Form Corr-22:** used for unimportant correspondence (with carbon paper).
- **Form Corr-40:** used for important correspondence.
- **Form S.K.-3 (Return):** used as an invoice when returning articles to the Depot (prepared in triplicate).
- **Form Genl-8A:** lease deed executed when non-residential departmental accommodation is let out to a private person.

### 3. Jurisdiction of Regional Forms Depots (Rule 292)

Each Forms Depot serves a defined group of Circles:

| Depot       | Circles Served                                                                                                          |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aligarh     | Delhi, J&K, Ambala (Haryana), Ludhiana (Punjab), Jaipur (Rajasthan), Lucknow (UP), Dehradun (Uttarakhand), Shimla (HP). |
| Nashik      | Ahmedabad (Gujarat), Bengaluru (Karnataka), Mumbai (Maharashtra), Nagpur, Bhopal (MP), Raipur (Chhattisgarh).           |
| Bhubaneswar | Hyderabad (Telangana), Vijayawada (AP), Patna (Bihar), Bhubaneswar (Odisha), Ranchi (Jharkhand).                        |
| Thrissur    | Kochi, Chennai (Tamil Nadu), Madurai.                                                                                   |
| Kolkata     | Kolkata (WB), Guwahati (Assam / NE), Silchar.                                                                           |





## 4. Land & Building Rules (Specifics)

- **Boundary verification (Rule 460):** Boundaries of departmental land must be verified by an officer not below the rank of Divisional Officer.
- **Residential excess (Rule 538-C):** Superintendents and First-Class Postmasters can sanction condonation of excess residential accommodation up to 100 sq. ft. where it cannot otherwise be utilised.
- **Private tenants (Rule 588):** When renting to private persons — rent is collected monthly in advance; 6 months' rent must be deposited as security; and the rent charged is the Standard Rent (FR 45-B) or the Market Rent, whichever is higher.
- **Fire extinguishers (Rule 580):** These are not stock items; they are purchased against rate / running contracts (through GeM, formerly DGS&D).

## 5. Miscellaneous High-Yield Points

- **Criminal Breach of Trust (Rule 394):** An official who removes marks or cancellations from service stamps in order to reuse them is liable for criminal breach of trust — historically under Section 409 IPC, now read with the corresponding provision of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023.
- **Contract copies (Rule 420/2):** Copies of contracts exceeding Rs. 50,000 must be furnished to the Audit Office for scrutiny.
- **Salutation (Rule 619):** In communications with officers of the Department, the subscription “Yours faithfully” should be used.

### FINAL REVISION TIP

When the Manual quotes an old rupee figure or refers to the IPC / CrPC / Indian Post Office Act 1898, mentally substitute the current position: **financial limits** → **DFPR / Schedule of Financial Powers**; **criminal law** → **BNS & BNSS, 2023**; **postal law** → **Post Office Act, 2023**; **procurement** → **GFR 2017 + GeM**. The procedural skeleton of the Manual stays the same; only the underlying figures and parent statutes have moved on.